Passé Composé

In French, the passé composé is equivalent to the **simple past and the present perfect tense** of English. It is mainly used to talk about:

- **Completed/finished actions in the past**: I finished the homework yesterday.
- **Chronological series of events**: I came; I saw; I conquered.
- **Repetition of past actions**: I wrote to her four times.

Past Tense Conjugation

For conjugation, two components are required: **a helping verb (Avoir or Être) in the present tense** & **the past participle of the actual verb** (the action of the sentence).

Subject + Être/Avoir (Present Tense) + Past Participle of the Actual Verb

Note: Most of the verbs take avoir as auxiliary. The past participle of the verbs conjugated with **avoir don't agree in gender and number with the subject**.

Examples with avoir as auxiliary

Français	English
Ils ont gagné le match.	They won the match.
L'avion a décollé à midi.	The plane took off at noon.
J'ai bien compris la situation.	I understood the situation well.
Nous avons vu de nombreux pays.	We have seen many countries.
Vous avez pris la route de Lyon.	You drove to Lyon.

Movement Verbs in French

allé, arrivé, venu, revenu,
entré, rentré, descendu, devenu,
sorti, parti, resté, retourné,
passé, monté, tombé, né et mort

All **movement and pronominal verbs** use **être** as their auxiliary verb.

Note: The past participle of verbs conjugated with **être agrees in gender and number with the subject.**

Examples with être as auxiliary

Français	English
Ils sont allé**s** au Canada.	They went to Canada.
Elle est rentré**e** tard.	She came back home late.
Elles sont resté**es** à la maison.	They stayed at home.
Il est parti en vacances.	He went on a vacation.
Tu es descendu(e) seul ?	Did you come downstairs alone?

Negation (using Être/Avoir as the Helping Verb)

Place **ne** and **pas** around the **auxiliary verb (être/avoir)** followed by the past participle.
Subject + Ne + Avoir/Être (Present Tense) + Past Participle

Français	English
Sylvie **n**'a **pas** fait ses devoirs.	Sylvie did not do her homework.
John **n**'est **pas** arrivé à l'heure.	John did not arrive on time.
Elles **ne** sont **pas** sorti**es** avec leurs amis.	They did not go out with their friends.
Sophie **n**'est **pas** venu**e** avec moi.	Sophie did not come with me.
Je **n'**ai **pas** pu vous répondre tout de suite.	I couldn't respond to you immediately.